THE PRACTICAL MINI GUIDE

8 places in Switzerland

Photography, seasons, visit lengths and useful links for eight Swiss day trips.



Inside this guide

Lake Oeschinen / Rhine Falls / Mount Rigi

01 / Bern · Kandersteg

Lake Oeschinen



Oeschinensee sits in a dramatic basin above Kandersteg and forms part of the Jungfrau-Aletsch UNESCO landscape. A gondola shortens the climb, followed by an easy approach to the lake; longer panoramic trails rise above the shore. Conditions, trail openings and lake access change with weather and season.

WHEN TO GO

May–October

VISIT LENGTH

Half or full day

Train to Kandersteg, walk or bus to gondola

Reserve transport on busy summer weekends and check trail status.

Read the destination guide

Official visitor information

02 / Schaffhausen · Neuhausen

Rhine Falls



The Rhine Falls spread across the river below Schaffhausen, with paths and viewing platforms on both banks. Schloss Laufen gives close access to the water; Neuhausen provides broad frontal views. Boats operate seasonally and connect visitors with the central rock when conditions allow.

WHEN TO GO

Year-round

VISIT LENGTH

2–4 hours

Train to Schloss Laufen am Rheinfall or Neuhausen Rheinfall

Visit both banks; summer water volume is often strongest.

Read the destination guide

Official visitor information

03 / Central Switzerland

Mount Rigi



Rigi rises between several lakes in Central Switzerland. Cog railways climb from Vitznau and Arth-Goldau, while boats create a classic round trip from Lucerne. Easy ridge walks, longer hikes and spa stops make the mountain flexible across seasons.

WHEN TO GO

Year-round

VISIT LENGTH

Half or full day

Boat to Vitznau or train to Arth-Goldau

Use the circular route to avoid repeating the same transport.

Read the destination guide

Official visitor information

04 / Vaud · Lake Geneva

Lavaux Vineyard Terraces



Lavaux stretches between Lausanne and Montreux, where stone-walled vineyards descend toward Lake Geneva. Walking routes pass wine villages, terraces and viewpoints over the lake and Savoy Alps. Trains and boats make it easy to combine one section of the trail with Vevey, Lausanne or Château de Chillon.

WHEN TO GO

April–October

VISIT LENGTH

Half or full day

Regional train to Cully, Rivaz or Saint-Saphorin

Walk one section and return by train; summer slopes have little shade.

Read the destination guide

Official visitor information

05 / Valais · Aletsch Arena

Great Aletsch Glacier



The Great Aletsch Glacier flows through the UNESCO Swiss Alps Jungfrau-Aletsch landscape. Viewpoints at Moosfluh, Bettmerhorn and Eggishorn reveal the glacier curving between high peaks. Cable cars make the panorama accessible without technical mountaineering, while marked trails connect car-free mountain villages.

WHEN TO GO

June–October

VISIT LENGTH

Full day

Train to Mörel or Betten, then cable car

Start early for clearer mountain views.

Read the destination guide

Official visitor information

06 / Neuchâtel Jura

Creux du Van



Creux du Van forms a natural rock arena roughly 150 metres high in the Jura. The rim opens toward broad views across the Swiss Plateau and Alps. Routes range from a direct approach near the upper plateau to a demanding circular hike from Noiraigue through forest and the Areuse valley.

WHEN TO GO

May–October

VISIT LENGTH

4–6 hours

Train to Noiraigue, then marked trail

Stay behind stone walls and away from cliff edges in fog or wind.

Read the destination guide

Official visitor information

07 / Bern · Swiss capital

Bern Old Town



Bern's medieval centre sits on a peninsula formed by the Aare. Six kilometres of covered arcades connect the station with Zytglogge, fountains, the cathedral and river viewpoints. The compact centre works in any weather and combines easily with the Rosengarten or a walk along the Aare.

WHEN TO GO

Year-round

VISIT LENGTH

Half or full day

Direct trains to Bern main station

Start at Rosengarten, then descend through the old town toward the station.

Read the destination guide

Official visitor information

08 / Eastern Switzerland

St. Gallen Abbey District



The Abbey District anchors St. Gallen's old town and belongs to UNESCO World Heritage. Its baroque cathedral and library preserve centuries of European learning. Pedestrian lanes, textile heritage and quick rail access make the city an easy cultural day trip, with Lake Constance and Alpstein nearby.

WHEN TO GO

Year-round

VISIT LENGTH

Half day

Direct train to St. Gallen

Check library opening times and combine with Three Ponds above town.

Read the destination guide

Official visitor information

Find your kind of day out

These eight places are ideas for separate trips, rather than a single-day itinerary. City walks, vineyards and high-mountain paths require different preparation. Journey time comes in addition to time spent at the destination.

Transport and access

Mountain lifts, trails and boat services depend on the season and weather. A travel pass does not necessarily cover every part of the journey. The destination’s official website explains access, current timetables and possible closures.

Good to know

Photography: author and licence details in the linked Sweezy destination guides. Check visiting conditions before travelling.

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